Colour for your website and business

Yes – but more as a mysterious spark than as the main voice.

In business violet is a colour that asks for attention, but **quietly**. It acts like a person wearing something nobody else picked, and it still suits them. It is creative, luxurious and a little mysterious, and that is why it is good to know what it promises before you let it into a logo, a website or an advertisement.

By itself, though, it **does not attract customers** like a magnet. It can help create a **distinctive impression**, but what still decides is mainly **what you sell**, **to whom** and **how well** it all works together.

What we are telling the customer

Violet can say, for example

"This is exceptional." "It is personal." "Here you can create." "It matters."

- **Luxury and rarity.** Violet long cost more than silver, and that stays with us. The customer reads that there is something exceptional here.
- **Creativity and originality.** It is linked with ideas, art and an unconventional approach.
- **Femininity and playfulness.** In combination with pink it is linked with femininity and sensuality.
- **Spirituality and depth.** It suits where you offer silence, transcendence or inner work.
- **Showiness.** Sometimes it is also linked with vanity. Beware of overdoing it.

Depending on the shade, though, it can also act differently. Lavender is **gentle and caring**, plum and wine **luxurious**, a rich violet **creative and striking**.

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Simple tips

As an accent, not a wall

It suits as the colour of a logo, button or detail. Mute large areas and balance them with light.

Shade by role

Lavender for gentleness and care, plum and wine for luxury, a rich violet for creativity and expression.

Combinations

Gold for prestige, white for purity, green for a natural contrast, yellow (its counterpart) for energy.

Cultural context

In Europe violet is luxury and the church, in Thailand the mourning of widows, in Japan nobility, in the women's movement a voice. Before you head out into the world, find out what violet means where you are and where they are.

Legibility

A light lavender on white is almost illegible. Use a darker shade and check the contrast.

Colour blindness

About 1 in 12 men has trouble telling red and green apart. Do not use these two colours as the only difference between two things.

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Professions where it is a Yes

The rule is simple. When you sell exceptionality, creativity and depth, violet will help you.

Cosmetics, fragrance, jewellery and personal care

Soft tones can accompany a more sensitive and personal expression, deeper shades feel more festive or sensual. **Let them tie in with a real material, scent or character of the service.** A lavender pack suggests itself where lavender has its place. It does not have to accompany every product just because it should give a calming impression.

Fashion, art and original work

It suits a gallery, a music project, a theatre or a distinctive personal brand. Try it as a frame for real photographs and works. **If a violet filter covers everything**, a visitor may recognise your colour, but no longer your work.

Wellness, meditation, coaching and therapy

Violet can be an understandable part of their symbolism, and that is exactly why it is good to watch the amount of other signs. A violet background, gold lettering, stars, a lotus and three glowing circles can already convey more mystery than a person needs when looking for a course date. **Let a visitor easily find out what you offer, who it is for and what she will actually experience there.**

Publishing, education, confectionery and culture

Luxury confectionery, festivals and cultural events have relied on violet since long ago. So has the personal brand of a woman who wants to show her own style.

Professions where it is a No

This is not a ban for whole fields. What decides is the interplay of colour, text, photographs and setting.

- **Banks, insurers and technical fields.** Where you sell austere reliability, a mysterious colour can distract.
- **Crisis and health help.** Over-mysterious styling can overshadow the concreteness and clarity of the service.
- **Operating information and long text.** Muted shades or a rich violet in the background are hard to read.
- **Presentation of colour-sensitive products.** Violet lighting or a filter can distort their real look.

Give important information clearly legible dark text.

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Before you send it out into the world

Show the design to a woman who does not know your offer and ask “What would you expect from such a place or service?” **Is the offer visible, or mainly the violet?** Her answer may tell you more than the general rule that violet means luxury.

A question for you

“What should your customer feel first when she looks at your website?”

Examples from the market

You know violet from chocolate, couriers and whisky. Here are **a few examples** that show what it can do.

- **Cadbury (chocolate)**
  The company launched Dairy Milk chocolate in 1905 and gave it a violet wrapper in 1914, in memory of Queen Victoria. A dispute with Nestlé over exclusive rights to a shade of violet ran into 2012 and 2013 and Cadbury did not manage to keep protection of the shade. The colour still became its signature.
- **Milka (chocolate)**
  Alpine chocolate Milka was created in 1901 at the Swiss maker Suchard. The violet and the violet cow from the adverts made it a brand you recognise even without the name.
- **FedEx (courier services)**
  Since 1994 the company has carried the name FedEx and a violet-and-orange logo. Violet here means reliability and size, orange energy. Between the E and the x in the logo hides an arrow pointing forward.
- **Crown Royal (whisky)**
  The Canadian whisky was created in 1939 for the visit of King George VI to Canada. A violet velvet bag with a gold drawstring makes it a gift that carries a feeling of royal celebration.

What they share is that violet carries a simple message. **Celebration, rarity, exceptionality**. And it is mostly not everywhere, only where it should stand out.

Colours in business are not law. Studies are mixed and a lot depends on context, on customers and on how consistent the brand is. Take it as an idea to test, not as a rule. The brand examples are publicly known and the facts about them come from public sources.

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